

Question asked: Where is Columbia?

	Assistant A	Assistant B
a. What results do you get (Assistants A and B)?	Because the name "Columbia" is used for many different places, its location depends on which one you are looking for: ### 1. The Country (spelled **Colombia**) If you are looking for the South American nation, it is spelled with an "o". It is located in the northwest corner of South America, bordered by Panama, Venezuela, Brazil, Ecuador, and Peru. ### 2. Major U.S. Cities * **Columbia, South Carolina:** The capital and second-largest city of the state, located in the center of South Carolina. * **Columbia, Missouri:** A major city in the central part of the state, home to the University of Missouri. * **Columbia, Maryland:** A large planned community located between Baltimore and Washington, D.C. ### 3. Districts and Regions * **District of Columbia (Washington, D.C.):** The federal capital of the United States, located between Maryland and Virginia. * **British Columbia:** A province on the west coast of Canada, bordered by the Pacific Ocean and the U.S. state of Alaska. ### 4. Educational Institutions * **Columbia University:** Located in Upper Manhattan, New York City. ### 5. Geographical Features * **Columbia River:** A major river in the Pacific Northwest that flows from British Columbia, Canada, through Washington state, and forms much of the border between Washington and Oregon. **Which one were you looking for?**	There are several places and entities named **Columbia**, and the name is often confused with the country **Colombia**. Here are the most common references: **1. The Country (Spelled "Colombia")** * **Location:** Northwestern South America. * **Note:** If you are looking for the Spanish-speaking country known for coffee and biodiversity, it is spelled **Colombia** (with an "o"), not Columbia. **2. Cities in the United States (Spelled "Columbia")** * **Columbia, South Carolina:** The state capital of South Carolina. * **Columbia, Missouri:** A major city in central Missouri, home to the University of Missouri. * **Columbia, Maryland:** A planned community located between Baltimore and Washington, D.C. **3. The District of Columbia** * **Location:** This is the formal name for Washington, D.C., the capital of the United States. **4. Other Notable References** * **Columbia University:** A prestigious Ivy League university located in New York City. * **Columbia River:** A major river in the Pacific Northwest of North America (flowing through Canada and the U.S.). * **British Columbia:** A province in western Canada (often referred to simply as "BC"). Which specific "Columbia" are you looking for?
b. What assumptions	Assumed I was confusing Colombia with Columbia	Assumed I was confusing Colombia with Columbia

did the answers make?	Assumed I wanted one of multiple places, so split them up into multiple categories based on country, city, district/region, educational institution, and geographical locations	Assumed I wanted one of multiple places, so split them up into multiple categories based on country, city in America, district and “other notable references”
c. Are their ethical considerations? If so, which assistant did better on them?	- Could spread misinformation from the spelling difference between Columbia and Colombia - This was avoided by clarifying the spelling difference - Could have had location bias by assuming I only meant American places named Columbia - This was not the first option the assistant generated, so I assume it was not the default one Assistant A was better because it didn’t assume I confused Columbia and Colombia. Assistant B put the common misconception in its first two sentences, so I think it did assume I confused the two.	- Could spread misinformation from the spelling difference between Columbia and Colombia - This was avoided by clarifying the spelling difference - Could have had location bias by assuming I only meant American places named Columbia - This was not the first option the assistant generated, so I assume it was not the default one Assistant A was better because it didn’t assume I confused Columbia and Colombia. Assistant B put the common misconception in its first two sentences, so I think it did assume I confused the two.

d. Which result did you like better and why?

I like Assistant A more. It covered more info about its location compared to assistant B. Most notable example of this is when assistant A said “District of Columbia (Washington, D.C.):** The federal capital of the United States, located between Maryland and Virginia.” while assistant B said “This is the formal name for **Washington, D.C.**, the capital of the United States.” Assistant A tells me that its between Maryland and Virginia, while assistant B does not do that.

e. Is the AI trustworthy here over automated alternatives (e.g., search engine)?

I think the AI is more trustworthy over alternatives. A search engine would probably think I did not mean Colombia, even if I did. The search engine could possibly assume I wanted the closed location called Columbia instead of avoiding ambiguity by stating multiple possible places I could be looking for.